

requirements exceed the available amount of RAM. While there's a way to use the Windows method (use a file instead of a partition for paging), it is recommended to use a separate partition for the swap. It's possible to make other partitions like `/var` (for storing files which change frequently) , `/boot` (boot files like kernel, ramdisk image, boot menu files etc), `/usr` (for installing most programs; it's similar to the program files folder for Windows) and any other to make the Windows partitions (NTFS partitons) available under Linux. However they're neither mandatory nor strongly recommended. We'll show you the Ubuntu installation alongside Windows (using Windows 7 as example) with creation of a root (`/`) partition and a swap partition.

Installation steps for a dual boot setup

So first insert the installation media into the computer and boot from it. Further steps are as mentioned below. Please note that the only difference between the steps that follow from those mentioned in the "Installing Ubuntu on a Machine with No OS" are those which are related to partitioning. We won't repeat them here in detail but only refer to the previous ones (with a brief inline description of the step).

Step 1: Choose your language. This step is the same as Step 1 of procedure for Ubuntu installation without an OS.

Step 2: Make sure you meet the system requirements for installation and click 'Forward'. Refer to Step 2 of "Installing Ubuntu as a standalone OS" for details.

Step 3: In this step, Ubuntu will ask you how you want to install Ubuntu. It shows you three options:

- ▶ **Install Ubuntu alongside Windows 7:** This is the most suitable option for us. When you select this option, Ubuntu looks into each partition, sees how much drive space is available and selects one which suits the best. Upon selecting it and pressing 'Forward', you'll be allowed to set the amount of space you want to allocate for Ubuntu on the selected drive; usually it's the one with most amount of space available.

The screen which offers you to allot the space to Ubuntu by resizing the selected partition, will also provide a link to the advanced partitioning tool. It's the same screen that appears when you select the 'Something else' option.